

Hima Shanthi Rayapati

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Education

Arizona State University, MS in Psychology (Cognition, Behavior, and Information)	08/2026 – 12/2027
Arizona State University, BS in Psychology and Mathematics (Statistics)	01/2023 – 05/2026
• Minor: Philosophy GPA: 4.0/4.0	

Research Experience

Research Assistant , <i>Thinking Across Languages and Contexts Lab</i> , ASU	08/2025 – Present
• Assist a graduate student with testing experiments built in jsPsych and JavaScript. • Help check whether data are recorded correctly and organized for analysis. • Perform exploratory data analysis and assist in interpreting experimental results under supervision.	
Research Assistant , <i>Perception, Action, Language & Meaning Lab</i> , ASU	08/2025 – Present
• Support participant training and assist with data collection in studies using VR, motion-capture, and eye-tracking. • Work with the lab's time-series behavioral data, learning how to clean, organize, and explore it. • Read papers and explore possible methods (e.g., multilevel vector autoregression) to understand which approaches might fit the lab's data. • Contribute to discussions by sharing preliminary notes and observations from trial analyses.	
Volunteer Research Assistant , <i>Longitudinal & Behavioral Data Science Lab</i> , ASU	08/2024 – 12/2024
• Participated in bi-weekly lab meetings, contributing to discussions and staying updated on research progress.	
Research Assistant , <i>Evolution, Ecology, and Social Behavior Lab</i> , ASU	08/2023 – 11/2023
• Assisted with survey design, pilot testing, data coding, and literature reviews in social cognition research. • Participated in lab meetings and contributed to discussions on study design and interpretation.	

Projects

Analyzing the Impact of AI on Stack Overflow Participation (NLP & Data Analysis)	<i>GitHub</i>
• Analyzed large-scale Stack Overflow data using Python to study changes in user behavior after AI tool releases. • Built time-series datasets and computed engagement metrics (answer rates, response time, retention) using Python. • Performed statistical comparisons and visualized platform-level trends. • Explored tag-based trends and basic NLP features to examine topic shifts.	
Stochastic Dual-Timescale Model of Learning (ODE & SDE Modeling)	<i>Final Project / 2025</i>
• Developed differential equation model of fast and slow learning processes. • Extended to stochastic framework to examine effects of noise. • Verified theoretical properties via simulation. • Linked model behavior to memory retention and learning variability.	
Cultural Differences in Trust: AI vs. Human Expert Decision-Making	<i>Research Proposal / 2025</i>
• Proposed cross-cultural study (Mexico vs. U.S.) on AI vs. human decision-making under conflict. • Outlined experimental design focusing on competence and legitimacy. • Formulated mixed-effects modeling approach for analysis. • Synthesized literature across cognition, decision-making, and human-AI interaction.	
Probabilistic Reward Learning Task using PsychoPy	<i>Reward Learning.com/2025</i>
• Designed probabilistic reward-learning task with informative vs. non-informative features.	

- Examined learning under uncertainty and perceptual noise.
- Collected and analyzed participant data using Python.

Trust in Advice: AI vs. Human Sources (Data Analysis & Written Report)

Trust in AI.com/2025

- Analyzed 30,000+ human-AI interactions to study effects of advice source.
- Modeled decision changes before and after advice exposure.
- Found advice correctness as primary driver, with modest AI-related effects.

Research Proposal: Mirror Neurons, Social Synchrony, and Collaborative Learning

Proposal.com/2025

- Proposed a research framework synthesizing human and animal literature on mirror neuron systems and social synchrony.
- Formulated hypotheses linking coordination mechanisms to collaborative learning outcomes.

Additional projects and full write-ups available at my portfolio.

Work Experience

Research Aide, ASU – Tempe, AZ

12/2024 – Present

- Review, categorize, and structure user-generated data to ensure quality and consistency.
- Assign relevant tags to comments for improved organization and searchability.
- Evaluate AI-generated tags on user comments against manual annotation standards, identifying error patterns and comparing performance across different prompt versions to guide refinement.
- Perform data cleaning tasks, identifying and correcting inconsistencies to maintain data accuracy.
- Work with databases to structure data and ensure accessibility for future use.

Lead Survey Assistant, ASU – Tempe, AZ

05/2023 – Present

- Conduct phone-based survey interviews with currently employed and recently graduated ASU students, ensuring accurate and comprehensive data collection by clarifying responses and addressing any ambiguities.
- Assist in the hiring process, including interviewing and evaluating candidates.
- Perform data cleaning and ensure the integrity of datasets for analysis.
- Train new student workers in survey procedures and oversee testing and calibration of survey tools.

Intern, Public Safety Crisis Solution – Phoenix, AZ

08/2024 – 11/2024

- Performed quantitative analysis to support research, program development, and accreditation documentation.
- Contributed research-based content on clinical procedures addressing first responders' mental health initiatives.

Advising Office Aide, ASU – Tempe, AZ

08/2023 – 05/2024

- Supported advising operations through scheduling, communication, and administrative workflows.
- Managed data entry, marketing/outreach materials, and front-desk support for students and staff.

Skills

- **Programming & Statistical Tools:** R, SAS, MATLAB, Python, JMP, JASP, SQL (Microsoft Access), Java, C, Bash, REST APIs
- **Machine Learning & NLP (Foundational):** Principal Component Analysis (PCA), Neural network basics, Supervised vs. Unsupervised learning, Model evaluation concepts, Introductory text analysis (Voyant Tools)
- **Experimental & Research Tools:** jsPsych, PsychoPy, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Qualtrics, SurveyMonkey
- **Data Analysis & Visualization:** Tableau, Excel, Google Sheets, Alteryx
- **Collaboration & Productivity:** Slack, Teams, Zoom, Word, Outlook, Adobe PowerPoint, OneDrive, Dropbox